Chapter 22

Action View

We've seen how the routing component determines which controller to use and how the controller chooses an action. We've seen how the controller and action between them decide what to render to the user. Normally, rendering takes place at the end of the action and involves a template. That's what this chapter is all about. Action View encapsulates all the functionality needed to render templates, most commonly generating HTML, XML, or JavaScript back to the user. As its name suggests, Action View is the view part of our MVC trilogy.

In this chapter, we'll start with templates, for which Rails provides a range of options. We will then cover a number of ways in which users provide input: forms, file uploads, and links. We'll complete this chapter by looking at a number of ways to reduce maintenance using helpers, layouts, and partials.